

HUAZI (AUSTIN) LI

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Profile

Finance professional with a Bachelor's in Economics and Finance, MSc in Economics, and buy-side experience building DCF and comparable company analyses at a Chinese securities firm. CFA Level I candidate pursuing CPA, with a view to enrolling in the CBV program. Combines valuation modeling with Python-based quantitative analysis. Relocated to Vancouver in 2025 and currently teaching accounting and economics while completing professional designations.

Experience

Investment Associate, 10/2023 to 01/2025

GF Securities (Shenzhen: 000776; HKEX: 1776) — Guangzhou, Guangdong, China

Built Python routines to retrieve listed-company price and fundamental data, and ran OLS regressions against market index returns to estimate equity betas with standard errors and confidence intervals.

Supported senior analysts in building DCF and comparable company valuation models covering food and agriculture sectors; analyzed 70 companies.

Conducted industry and company research and verified financial data against audited statements to support investment memoranda.

Freelance Machine Learning Engineer, 08/2024 to present

Freelance

- Develop and evaluate machine learning models for financial and macroeconomic forecasting applications.

Math, Accounting, AP Economics Teacher, 06/2025 to present

BLUBC — Vancouver, BC

- Teach senior secondary accounting, finance and AP Economics, including financial statement preparation, analysis and interpretation.

Economics and Statistics Tutor, 12/2020 to 08/2023

Look4 Inc. — Hybrid

- Taught undergraduate economics and statistics, including regression analysis and statistical inference.

Education

Master of Science: Data Science, graduated in 06/2020, University of British Columbia – Vancouver, BC

Master of Science: Economics Science, 2014-2016 Baylor University - Waco, TX

Bachelor: Economics and Finance, 2008-2012 Washington State University - Pullman, WA

Skills

- Data and IT: Python, R, SAS, Tableau, SQL, JavaScript, CSS
- Economics: applied micro/macro analysis, industry and firm strategy, transfer pricing
- Finance: financial accounting, managerial accounting, corporate finance
- Accounting: financial and managerial accounting, budgeting and forecasting
- Designations: CFA Level I candidate; CPA in progress; CBV enrolment planned
- Excel: three-statement and LBO modeling, circular reference resolution via iterative calculation, scenario and sensitivity analysis, INDEX-MATCH/XLOOKUP, Power Query
- Python: regression modelling and statistical analysis
- Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native), Cantonese

Financial Modelling Projects

DCF and Trading Comparables Valuation — Activision Blizzard (NASDAQ: ATVI) | 2022

- Built a WACC from first principles: CAPM cost of equity (risk-free rate, equity beta, equity risk premium) and a principal-weighted blended cost of debt across five debt tranches, capital-structure weighted to 8.8%.
- Projected five years of unlevered free cash flow (EBIT to NOPAT, adjusted for D&A, net working capital and capital expenditure) and discounted to a perpetuity-growth terminal value; cross-checked the terminal assumption by solving for the implied exit EV/EBITDA multiple of 13.0x.
- Benchmarked the result against seven listed peers on LTM EV/Revenue and EV/EBITDA with high, mean, median and low statistics, plus a forward multiple bridge across the forecast horizon; derived an implied value of \$71.41 per share against a \$65.90 market price.

Leveraged Buyout Model — PetSmart, Inc. (\$6.2B transaction) | 2025

- Built a five-year integrated three-statement LBO with a four-tranche capital structure and a covenant-constrained cash sweep waterfall (MIN/MAX caps on mandatory amortization and optional prepayment); constructed the purchase price allocation — PP&E and intangible step-ups, deferred tax liability on the write-up, residual goodwill — and the enterprise-to-equity bridge with treasury-stock-method dilution.
- Resolved circular interest (interest to net income to cash flow to debt balance) via iterative calculation with a circuit-breaker toggle; diagnosed and repaired an inherited model containing an under-determined debt schedule that Excel was silently resolving to zero, and a hardcoded balance-sheet check that masked a reconciliation failure. Balance sheet ties to nil in every period.
- Built two-way sensitivity grids (exit multiple × exit year; exit multiple × terminal-year EBITDA) reconciled to the model's IRR output.

Models and supporting workbooks: github.com/AustinLee2024/Finance